Microsoft Press

# Computer Dictionary

Third Edition

Microsoft® Press

001 ServiceNow's Exhibit No. 1010

PUBLISHED BY
Microsoft Press
A Division of Microsoft Corporation
One Microsoft Way
Redmond, Washington 98052-6399

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Library of Congress Cataloging-in-Publication Data pending.

ISBN 1-57231-743-4

Printed and bound in the United States of America.

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 QMQM 2 1 0 9 8 7

Distributed to the book trade in Canada by Macmillan of Canada, a division of Canada Publishing Corporation.

A CIP catalogue record for this book is available from the British Library.

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**ISO/OSI MODEL**

| *ISO/OSI layer* | *Focus* |
|---|---|
| Application (highest level) | Program-to-program transfer of information |
| Presentation | Text formatting and display, code conversion |
| Session | Establishing, maintaining, and coordinating communication |
| Transport | Accurate delivery, service quality |
| Network | Transport routes, message handling and transfer |
| Data-link | Coding, addressing, and transmitting information |
| Physical | Hardware connections |

**ISP** \I`S-P´\ *n.* Acronym for **I**nternet **s**ervice **p**rovider. A business that supplies Internet connectivity services to individuals, businesses, and other organizations. Some ISPs are large national or multinational corporations that offer access in many locations, while others are limited to a single city or region. *Also called* access provider, service provider.

**ISV** \I`S-V´\ *n. See* independent software vendor.

**.it** \dot`I-T´\ *n.* On the Internet, the major geographic domain specifying that an address is located in Italy.

**italic** \i-tal´ik, ī-tal´ik\ *n.* A type style in which the characters are evenly slanted toward the right. *This sentence is in italics.* Italics are commonly used for emphasis, foreign-language words and phrases, titles of literary and other works, technical terms, and citations. *See also* font family. *Compare* roman.

**iterate** \it´ər-āt`\ *vb.* To execute one or more statements or instructions repeatedly. Statements or instructions so executed are said to be in a loop. *See also* iterative statement, loop.

**iterative statement** \it´ər-ə-tiv stāt`mənt\ *n.* A statement in a program that causes the program to repeat one or more statements. Examples of iterative statements in Basic are FOR, DO, REPEAT..UNTIL, and DO..WHILE. *See also* control statement.

**ITI** \I`T-I´\ *See* Intelligent Transportation Infrastructure.

**I-time** \I´tīm\ *n. See* instruction time.

**ITR** \I`T-R´\ *n. See* Internet Talk Radio.

**ITU** \I`T-U´\ *n. See* International Telecommunications Union.

**IVUE** \I´vyōō\ *n.* A proprietary image format (from Live Pictures) that allows files to be adjusted to screen resolution at any zoom level.

**i-way** \I´wā\ *n. See* Information Superhighway.



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ments, such as Microsoft Windows, a unit of information passed among running programs, certain devices in the system, and the operating environment itself.

**message header** \mes´əj hed`ər\ *n.* A sequence of bits or bytes at the beginning of a message that usually provides a timing sequence and specifies such aspects of the message structure as its length, data format, and block identification number. *See also* header (definition 2).

**message of the day** \mes`əj əv dhə dā´\ *n.* A daily bulletin for users of a network, multiuser computer, or other shared system. In most cases, users are shown the message of the day when they log into the system. *Acronym:* MOTD (M`O-T-D´).

**message queue** \mes´əj kyōō`\ *n.* An ordered list of messages awaiting transmission, from which they are taken up on a first in, first out (FIFO) basis.

**message reflection** \mes´əj rə-flek`shən\ *n.* In object-oriented programming environments, such as Visual C++, OLE, and ActiveX, a function that allows a control to handle its own message. *See also* ActiveX controls, control (definition 2), OCX, VBX.

**Message Security Protocol** \mes`əj se-kyər`i-tē prō´tə-kol\ *n.* A protocol for Internet messages that is based on the use of encryption and verification to ensure security. It also allows for permissions at the server level for delivery or rejection of e-mail. *Acronym:* MSP (M`S-P´).

**message switching** \mes´əj swich`ēng\ *n.* A technique used on some communications networks in which a message, with appropriate address information, is routed through one or more intermediate switching stations before being sent to its destination. On a typical message-switching network, a central computer receives messages, stores them (usually briefly), determines their destination addresses, and then delivers them. Message switching enables a network both to regulate traffic and to use communications lines efficiently. *Compare* circuit switching, packet switching.

**messaging** \mes´ə-jēng\ *n.* The use of computers and data communication equipment to convey messages from one person to another, as by e-mail, voice mail, or fax.

**messaging application** \mes´ə-jēng a-plə-kā`shən\ *n.* An application that enables users to send messages (such as e-mail or fax) to each other.

**Messaging Application Programming Interface** \mes`ə-jēng a-plə-kā-shən prō´gram-ēng in`tər-fās\ *n. See* MAPI.

**messaging client** \mes´ə-jēng klī`ənt\ *n.* An application program that enables its user to send or receive messages (such as e-mail or fax) to and from other users with the help of a remote server.

**metacharacter** \met´ə-kâr`ək-tər\ *n.* A character embedded in a program source or a data stream that conveys information about other characters, rather than itself representing a character. A simple example is the backslash (\) character, which, when used in strings in the C programming language, indicates that the letter following the backslash is part of an escape sequence that enables C to display a nongraphic character. *See also* escape character.

**metacompiler** \met´ə-kəm-pī`lər\ *n.* A compiler that produces compilers. The UNIX utility *yacc* (Yet Another Compiler-Compiler) is a metacompiler. If it is given a language specification, yacc produces a compiler for that language. *See also* compiler (definition 2).

**Meta-Content Format** \met`ə-kon´tent fōr`mat\ *n.* An open format for describing information about content of a structured body of data such as a Web page, a set of files on a Windows desktop, or a relational database. Meta-Content Format might be used for indexes, data dictionaries, or price lists. *Acronym:* MCF (M`C-F´).

**meta data** or **metadata** \met´ə dā`tə, dat`ə\ *n.* Data about data. For example, the title, subject, author, and size of a file constitute meta data about the file. *See also* data dictionary, repository.

**Metadata Interchange Specification** \met`ə-dā`tə in´tər-chānj spes-ə-fə-kā`shən\ *n.* A set of specifications dealing with the exchanging, sharing, and managing of meta data. *Acronym:* MDIS (M`D-I-S´). *See also* meta data.

**metafile** \met´ə-fīl`\ *n.* A file that contains or defines other files. Many operating systems use metafiles to contain directory information about other files on a given storage device.



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